

Tile Thickness: Which Records Belong?

AP Statistics · Unit 1 · Topics 1.1–1.2 (CED 1.1–1.2)

[STAR] THE PROBLEM

Suppose a ceramics cooperative inspects 12 tiles. The question is: *Do more than 25% of these 12 inspected tiles have thickness greater than 8 millimeters (mm)?* All 12 measurements are valid, and the inspection rule includes every inspected tile.

Stage codes mean 1 = formed, 2 = bisque-fired, and 3 = glazed. A studio ZIP code identifies a postal area. Each table row below describes one tile; repeated values represent distinct tiles.

Stage code	Studio ZIP code	Thickness (mm)
1	02139	6
1	02139	7
1	02139	7
1	02139	9
2	05301	6
2	05301	7
2	05301	8
2	05301	9
3	02139	7
3	05301	8
3	02139	10
3	05301	11

Proposal A: Keep all 12 records and report the share above 8 mm.

Proposal B: Omit the 10-mm and 11-mm tiles as unusually thick, report the remaining share, and announce that the cooperative meets the stated inspection criterion. No measurement error was found.

FIRST TAKE — one sentence before you work the parts

Which proposal would you provisionally use to answer the inspection question? Give one reason.

[BOOK] NOTES: CONTEXT, LABELS, AND PERCENTS

Individuals are the objects described by the data; variables are recorded characteristics. Quantitative variables measure amounts with units. Categorical variables identify groups; numeric codes may label ordered stages or places without measuring amounts. Variation means that a variable takes different values across individuals.

A contextual report names the individuals, variable, units, and question. A percentage is $100 \times \text{qualifying count} / \text{total count}$; percentage-point change is new percent minus old percent. State the denominator and disclose omitted records. A reporting decision should address the stated question and inclusion rule.

Work (a)–(d).

DOK 1 (a) Identify the individuals, the measured thickness variable, and its unit. State in words what counts as exceeding the threshold. Checklist: object; characteristic; unit; comparison boundary.

DOK 2 (b) Classify stage code, studio ZIP code, and thickness as categorical or quantitative. Explain what each code represents and why numerical appearance alone does not justify averaging it. Explain what variation in thickness means here, citing two table values. Checklist: three classifications; meanings of both codes; two measurements; contextual explanation.

DOK 2 (c) Calculate the percentage above 8 mm under each proposal, rounded to one decimal place. Give the change from A to B in percentage points and interpret both percentages in context. Checklist: qualifying counts; denominators; calculations; units; which tiles each percent describes.

DOK 3 (d) ★ Recommend A, B, or a revised report to answer the original inspection question. Defend your decision with both percentages and the inclusion rule. Address the objection that unusually thick tiles should be removed merely because their thicknesses vary. Explain why averaging stage or ZIP codes would not resolve the decision. The optional frame below supports only the code explanation.

To earn an E, your answer must do ALL of these (some = P; one or none = I):

- ☐ State what each percentage is a percent OF, and compare the correct one with the 25% limit.
- ☐ Recommend A, B, or a revised report, using the rule for which records belong.
- ☐ Explain what varying thickness means and whether variation alone justifies deleting a record.
- ☐ Say what stage codes and ZIP codes each stand for, and why averaging them answers nothing.

Frame: Stage and ZIP codes are _____; they represent _____ and _____.
variable type *stage meaning* *place meaning*

Thickness is _____, measured in _____.
variable type *unit*

Word bank: quantitative · postal areas · distances · production stages · millimeters · percentages · kilograms · categorical Some words are not needed.

Turn this sheet in whenever you finish — bonus credit. Part (d) is scored E / P / I.